

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: Myths and legends - Do you know the difference?



Learning Outcome

Describe hypothetical situations in written and spoken interactions according to work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Can you think of any myths or legends you learned while you were growing up?
- What is the difference between a myth and a legend?

Can Do Statements

- I can write about myths and legends.
- I can quote other people in writing.
- I can write about reactions and behaviors in different situations.





Let's Explore!

Do you like listening to Greek myths or the legend of **Robin Hood***?

* "Robin Hood" was England's greatest outlaw hero who lived in the 14th century.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Everyone loves a good story. The art of storytelling has been a fixture in every culture since the beginning of civilization. Most people say that they had their own favorite story from their youth. Often they found these stories frightening, exciting, and above all, engaging.

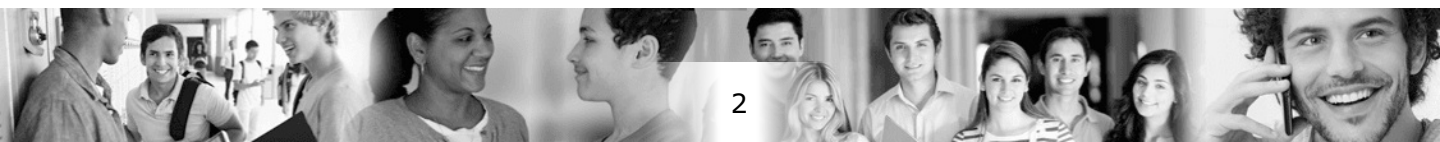
Myths and legends had offered listeners a glimpse into cultures, symbols and character and were used to help explain events in society. Experts have said that myths and legends provided an insight into our fears and the state of society.

Many have asked about the differences between myths and legends.

We refer to ancient, traditional stories of heroes or gods as myths. In these tales, characters were forced to deal with problems or issues, explain a fact or handle a natural occurrence. People had used stories to explain universal and local beginnings and the existence of supernatural beings. Tales of Greek and Roman deities and heroes are commonly referred to as myths and have enthralled listeners throughout human history.

On the other hand, legends are stories that had passed down through generations. Legends are told as if they were historical events, rather than as an explanation for something or a symbolic narrative. Usually, they were created with some element of truth or fact, but they are surrounded with "mythical qualities." Legends are often connected to a culture's spiritual beliefs. They involve heroic characters such as the outlaw Robin Hood. He was stealing from the rich to give to the unfortunate.

Some have said that these kinds of stories had helped generations understand how people in the past saw, and understood, the world around them.





Let's Practice!

Myths and legends have a special place in our life. You can quote* storytellers on that!

*When you "quote someone on that", it means you can trust what they say.

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. had / favorite / their / Most / their / youth / own / that / story / from / . / people / they / say

2. Experts / tried / have / to / the / . / creation / that / said / the / myths / of / world / explain

3. asked / readers / . / became / heroic / have / Many / characters / legends / how

4. historical / from / wonder / their / whether / Readers / myths / inspiration / took / . / events

5. said / stories / helped / of / Some / the / have / saw / around / them. / understand / people / these / kinds / generations / how / had / world / that





Let's Practice!

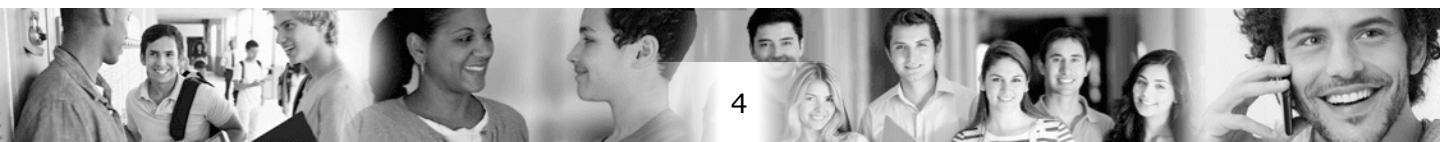
Why are myths and legends so important to us?

Instructions: Choose the expressions from the word bank to correctly complete the sentences.

Word Bank

- was stolen
- was stealing
- founded
- found
- was
- had offered
- had used
- were offering
- had passed
- were used

1. Myths and legends _____ listeners a glimpse into cultures, symbols and character and _____ to help explain events in society.
2. Often readers _____ these stories frightening, exciting and, above all, engaging.
3. People _____ myths to explain universal and local beginnings and the existence of supernatural beings.
4. Legends are stories that _____ down through generations and involve heroic characters such as the outlaw Robin Hood.
5. Robin Hood _____ a legendary hero because he _____ from the rich to give to the unfortunate.





Extension Activity

Compare two myths or legends from different countries.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Find 2 myths or legends, each from a different country.
- Read them and note how they are the same and how they are different.
- Now write two paragraphs, one discussing the similarities with support and one discussing the difference with support.
- Read your paragraphs to a partner.
- Check for spelling and grammar errors in the paragraphs together.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I find 2 myths or legends, each from a different country.

☐ ☐

I make notes on their similarities and differences.

☐ ☐

I write two paragraphs to explain the similarities and differences.

☐ ☐

I support my ideas.

☐ ☐

I share my paragraphs with a partner.

☐ ☐

I check for spelling and grammar mistakes.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- fixture** (noun): something long established
e.g. The art of storytelling has been a fixture in every culture.
- glimpse** (noun): a quick idea or understanding of what something is like
e.g. Myths and legends had offered listeners a glimpse into cultures and symbols.
- state** (noun): a way of living or existing
e.g. Experts have said that myths and legends provided an insight into our fears and the state of society.
- universal** (adjective): existing or true at all times or in all places
e.g. People had used stories to explain universal and local beginnings.
- supernatural** (noun): relating to or seeming to come from magic, a god, etc.
e.g. Supernatural beings had been explained in myths.
- to enthrall** (verb): to hold the attention by being very exciting, interesting, or beautiful
e.g. Myths have enthralled listeners throughout human history.
- element** (noun): a specific part of something
e.g. Legends were created with some element of truth or fact.



Learning Points

Reported Speech and Questions

You use a reporting verb like *to say* or *to tell* to report what someone said in a conversation.

For example: She said (that) my cat needed some additional tests.

When you tell people what someone has said in the past, you generally make the verb tense 'more in the past'. You need to change the verb to the next past form.

For example:

Direct speech	Reported speech
"I like him."	He said he liked him.
"I'm coming to the party."	He said he was coming .
"I already ate ."	He said he had already eaten.
"I can cook."	He told me he could cook
"Where do you live ?"	He asked me where I lived .

You have to change the pronoun if you are reporting what someone else said. Compare these two sentences. In each case the person actually said "I don't want to go."

- I said, "I don't want to go." > I said **I** didn't want to go.
- Bill said, "I don't want to go." > Bill said **he** didn't want to go.

You usually introduce reported questions with the verb *to ask*.

Here are some examples:

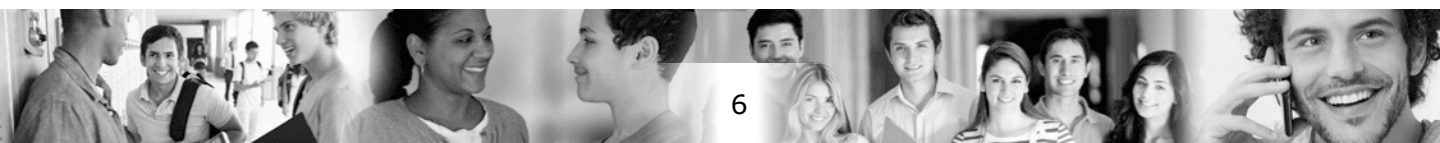
The expert **asked** (me) **if/whether** ... (YES/NO questions)

The nurse **asked** (me) **why/when/where/what/how** ... (question-word questions)

You may need to change pronouns and tense as well as time and place in reported questions.

The word order is like that of a normal statement:

(subject-verb-object)





Learning Points

Look at the chart below to see the changes in verb tense.

Direct speech	Reported speech
Simple Present	Simple Past
Present Progressive	Past Progressive
Simple Past	Past Perfect
Present Perfect	Past Perfect
Past Progressive	Past Perfect Progressive
Future Simple (will)	Conditional (would)
Modal Can	Modal Could
Modal May	Modal Might
Modal Will	Modal Would

Examples:

- *Some have said that these kind of stories had helped them to understand how people in the past saw, and understood, the world around them.*
- *Experts said that myths and legends offered insight into our fears and the state of society.*
- *They asked whether myths and legends are still talked about.*





Learning Points

Writing in the past tense

You often use the Simple Past and the Past Continuous tenses together. You use the Past Perfect tense to identify and talk about an 'earlier past'.

*I **was just reading** a legend about Bigfoot.*

You can use the Simple Past tense to refer to a shorter action that happened in the middle of, or interrupted, the longer action.

*We **read** a story about a legend around the campfire.*

When you are talking about a past event, you can refer to something that happened at an earlier time to that past event by using the Past Perfect tense.

The structure of the Past Perfect is:

Subject + had + past participle

*I **had believed** that myths and legends were the same thing.*

You use the Past Perfect tense (not Simple Past) when you want to talk about how long something had continued **up to a past moment**.

Examples:

- *Some have said that these kinds of stories had helped generations understand how people in the past saw, and understood, the world around them.*
- *Often they found these stories frightening, exciting and above all, engaging.*
- *He was stealing from the rich to give to the unfortunate.*
- *Myths and legends had offered listeners a glimpse into cultures, symbols and character and used to help explain events in society.*

